

...drawing with a pencil seems to have higher energy cost than using generative AI!?

Posted by u/AcanthisittaBorn8304 • • 0 points • 62 comments

It's mostly due to the refinement process for the graphite core.

I gotta say... I'm baffled.

That's the *very last* argument by antis I would have expected to crumble to dust in light of facts.

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-10 13:38 UTC

[removed]

u/Elven77AI • 3 points • 2025-09-24 17:31 UTC

The equivalent of one image generation is ~30s of gaming.
Gamers do it all day, no environmental panic.

The cost of one manual image involves spending far more limited and expensive food energy(muscle power, mental effort) for much longer time. The more traditional tools requires cellulose(dead trees) from paper mills and paint/graphite/ink from chemical factories(both have enormous environmental impact).

The current meme of "AI datacenters killing the planet" is just because some corporations pick the cheapest electricity sources for the datacenters(fossil fuels) but electricity itself can be green - paper/ink/graphite will never be green, they are unlike graphics cards single-purpose consumables. A single graphics card if producing images in an AI datacenter replaces millions of canvases and pencils over its lifetime, saving entire forests and removing clouds of chemicals from existing. Artists insisting on enabling this archaic "chemical art pipeline" are the same as analog photographers enabling vast industry of photo chemicals and film materials.

u/Cass0wary_399 • 1 points • 2025-09-24 23:23 UTC

Your comment is completely ideologically motivated and the reason why Anti-AI radicalized, you are everything AI bros are accused of being. I am still not going to let go of my pencils and paper, Pro-AI traditional artists who has "adapted to AI" that by default end up in the same camp as you against their better judgement won't give it up for your Reddit comment either.

This whole argument reeks of the hyper focus on plastic straws killing turtles over all the other

plastic wastes. I am convinced that you are a shill trying to hide the cost of mining raw materials for your precious graphics cards.

[Read this.](<https://www.carbonbrief.org/emissions-from-mining-cause-up-to-2-5tn-in-environmental-damages-each-year/>)

Singling out the production of traditional art supplies as the reason for rainforests being cleared is asinine and wrong. Anything made of paper and wood does that. There are way more disposable and single use paper products than paper for art. Toilet paper and paper packaging used on literally every product, including on the so called “green” graphics cards, that are way more disposable and widely used. What do you propose replaces all that paper and wood, if you are so extremist that you hyperfocus on paper’s environmental impact over all else?

Plastic is the only other alternative to paper.

Mining cannot be fully green either, way less so than pencil and paper. Mining raw materials for graphics cards still causes environmental damage, where mines opens up whatever forest that was there would be permanently cut down for mining and cause land degradation. The mining operation involves heavy machinery that also pollutes the area from both emissions and exposing heavy metals to the surface. The supply chain needed to get the materials to manufacture the graphics cards is still as polluting as transportation used by all supply chains.

Cheap pencils and paper do not need wood from far away rainforests, but instead managed forests that’s much closer to the market and thus less emissions on transportation. One of the biggest factors contributing to deforestation of rainforests is local farmers clearing land via burning, the wood doesn’t even get used.

You will take mine, no our pencils, paper and canvases away off our dead body. Get your extremist shit outta here, you don’t truly care for climate change or the environment when you try to gaslight people into thinking art supplies causes more environmental damage than mining raw materials for electronics like graphics cards.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-09-24 13:30 UTC

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